Body Doubling

In short

Working next to someone else can make it easier to focus and start a task. They don’t need to do the same work. Try a quiet video call with colleagues, or sit near someone who’s focusing.

Overview

Body doubling is when you work alongside another person to help you focus. The other person doesn't need to be working on the same task as you. Having them there helps you keep your attention on your task. It's a popular strategy used by many neurodivergent people to do boring or difficult jobs, such as cleaning.

Body doubling makes it easier to get started on a task. Having someone else in the room or on a video call creates a sense of accountability, stopping the feeling of isolation and reducing the urge to procrastinate.

You can try this with your colleagues by setting up quiet 'co-working' sessions. Just start a video call together, state your goals, and then get to work. You can also do this in the office by sitting near someone who's also trying to focus. It's all about sharing the same productive energy.

Useful links

- The ADHD Body Double: A Unique Tool for Getting Things Done
- ADHD Body Doubling
- Neurodiversity Cafe: Body Doubling

Abbreviations

The full form of each abbreviation used in this document.

ADHD: Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder